



ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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SCHOLARSHIPS, FREESHIPS & FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE POLICY

Preamble

St. Ann's College for Women is committed to ensuring equitable access to higher education by providing financial support and assistance to deserving and economically disadvantaged students. The institution believes that no student should be deprived of education due to financial constraints.

This Scholarships, Freeships & Financial Assistance Policy is framed in accordance with the guidelines of the University Grants Commission (UGC), National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC), Government of Andhra Pradesh, affiliating university norms, and institutional values of inclusiveness and social responsibility.

The college facilitates scholarships, freeships, fee concessions, and financial aid through government schemes, institutional support, philanthropists, and welfare initiatives for the holistic development and academic continuity of students.

Objectives of the Policy

The objectives of this policy are to:

- Promote equal educational opportunities for all students.
- Support economically weaker and socially disadvantaged students.
- Encourage meritorious students to pursue higher education.
- Reduce dropout rates due to financial difficulties.
- Facilitate awareness and access to government scholarship schemes.
- Provide timely guidance and assistance in scholarship application processes.
- Promote inclusiveness, women empowerment, and educational equity.

Scope of the Policy

This policy applies to students belonging to:

- Economically weaker sections
- Scheduled Castes (SC)
- Scheduled Tribes (ST)
- Backward Classes (BC)
- Minority communities
- Differently-abled students (Divyangjan)

- Meritorious students
- Single-parent or vulnerable backgrounds
- Students facing financial hardship

Types of Financial Support

The institution facilitates the following forms of financial assistance:

Government Scholarships

Eligible students are encouraged and assisted to apply for scholarships offered by:

- Government of Andhra Pradesh
- University Grants Commission (UGC)
- Social Welfare Department
- Tribal Welfare Department
- Minority Welfare Department
- Backward Classes Welfare Department
- Other State and Central Government agencies

Freeships & Fee Concessions

The institution may provide:

- Partial fee concessions
- Full or partial freeships for deserving students
- Special consideration for economically disadvantaged students
- Emergency financial support in genuine cases

Merit Scholarships

Meritorious students with outstanding academic performance may be encouraged and supported through:

- Institutional merit recognition
- Fee concessions subject to institutional policies
- Recommendations for external scholarships and awards

Financial Assistance & Student Support

Financial assistance may also be provided through:

- Alumni support
- Philanthropic contributions
- Institutional welfare initiatives

- Sponsorships and donor support schemes

Eligibility Criteria

Financial support may be provided based on:

- Academic merit
- Family income
- Social category
- Government eligibility norms
- Attendance and discipline
- Genuine financial need
- Institutional recommendations

Students must submit required documents and certificates as prescribed by the institution or concerned authorities.

Institutional Support Mechanism

The college shall:

- Create awareness regarding available scholarships and welfare schemes.
- Assist students in filling scholarship applications and uploading documents.
- Provide guidance regarding eligibility, deadlines, and procedures.
- Verify and forward applications to appropriate authorities.
- Maintain transparency and confidentiality in the selection and support process.
- Monitor scholarship utilization and student progression.

Scholarship Assistance Committee

The institution may constitute a Scholarship/Financial Assistance Committee to:

- Disseminate scholarship information
- Guide students regarding application procedures
- Verify student documents
- Recommend deserving cases for institutional support
- Maintain records of beneficiaries
- Coordinate with government departments and agencies

Responsibilities of Students

Students availing scholarships or financial assistance shall:

- Submit genuine and valid documents.
- Maintain satisfactory attendance and academic progress.
- Follow institutional rules and code of conduct.
- Utilize financial assistance responsibly.
- Inform the institution regarding any changes in eligibility status.

Transparency & Non-Discrimination

The institution shall ensure:

- Equal opportunity and fair treatment to all eligible students.
- Transparency in scholarship guidance and support procedures.
- Non-discrimination on the basis of caste, religion, gender, language, disability, or socio-economic status.
- Confidential handling of financial and personal information.

Monitoring & Review

The implementation of this policy shall be periodically reviewed by:

- College Administration
- IQAC
- Scholarship/Financial Assistance Committee
- Student Welfare Committee

The institution shall monitor:

- Number of beneficiaries
- Utilization of scholarships
- Student progression and retention
- Impact of financial support on academic continuity

Expected Outcomes

The implementation of this policy is expected to:

- Improve access to higher education for disadvantaged students
- Reduce financial barriers and dropout rates
- Enhance student retention and progression
- Promote academic excellence and inclusiveness
- Strengthen women empowerment through education
- Support holistic student development

Policy Review

This policy shall be reviewed periodically in accordance with UGC, NAAC, Government, and university guidelines to ensure effectiveness and continuous improvement.

Conclusion

St. Ann's College for Women is committed to supporting students through scholarships, freeships, and financial assistance mechanisms that ensure equal educational opportunities and academic continuity. The institution strives to empower young women through accessible, affordable, and inclusive higher education.